

Review Questions

1. Describe and compare the six sources of software.
2. How can you decide among various off-the-shelf software options? What criteria should you use?
3. What is an RFP, and how do analysts use one to gather information about hardware and system software?
4. What methods can a systems analyst employ to verify vendor claims about a software package?
5. What are ERP systems? What are the benefits and disadvantages of such systems as a design strategy?
6. Explain reuse and its advantages and disadvantages.
7. Compare and contrast the four approaches to reuse.
8. Why would a company rely on cloud computing for its software needs?

Part 1

Review questions

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1. Information technology services firms
2. packaged software providers
3. vendors of enterprise solutions software
4. cloud computing
5. open-source software
6. in-house development

develop, host & run
applications for
customers

IT services firms

employ people with expertise
in the development of IT &
business

develop prepackaged /
off-the-shelf systems

the system will not be opened
until testing is completed

packaged software
producers

run on many different
computer platforms
(microcomputers → large mainframes)

consist of a series of
integrated modules

vendors of enterprise
solution software

modules are flexible because
additional modules can be
added as needed once the basic
system is in place

provision of applications over the
Internet

includes many areas
of technology including
software

cloud computing

Disadvantages

1. implementation takes long
time to complete

2. must rely on consultants /
employees of software vendors

Benefits

1. gaining access to applications faster than via
internal development
2. achieving lower-cost access to corporate-
quality applications

1. accounting
2. distribution
3. manufacturing
4. human resources

freely available



open-source software



developed and maintained by communities of people



how to make money

1. provide maintenance & other services
2. provide one version of software for free
3. sell more fully-featured version

need not entail development of all software that will compose the total system



in-house development

some in-house components are reused.

